A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

01 May 2026

Dr Glen Guerra
Melbourne Colorectal Specialists

Dear Dr Guerra,

Re: Ms Harpreet Kaur
DOB: 26/05/1994 Phone: 0466 941 778
Address: 1 Tamar Avenue, POINT COOK, VIC, 3030
Email: harpreetkaur26@gmail.com
Medicare: 3616347973 / 1

Summary

- **isolated perianal Crohn's disease, currently managed with infliximab and azathioprine.**
- **Mildly deranged liver function tests requiring repeat evaluation in two weeks.**
- **Vitamin B12 and Vitamin D deficiency.**

I had the pleasure of conducting a telehealth review with Harpreet Kaur. She has recently commenced induction therapy with infliximab. She has also restarted her azathioprine. Encouragingly, she has tolerated these medications well, and while it is premature to definitively assess the clinical efficacy of the biological therapy, she reports that her perianal fistula drainage has improved significantly compared to last year.

Harpreet's recent pathology demonstrates that her inflammatory markers are well-controlled, with a CRP of less than 5 mg/L and a normal white cell count. There is no evidence of bone marrow suppression from the azathioprine. However, her liver function tests are mildly deranged. While this can be a side effect of azathioprine, the current profile may also be related to a recent illness and antibiotic use. I have requested repeat blood tests in a fortnight to monitor these levels closely.

Regarding her nutritional status, Harpreet is deficient in vitamin B12 (146 pmol/L) and vitamin D (27 nmol/L). Her iron stores are currently within the low-normal range. We discussed how these deficiencies likely contribute to her current fatigue.

We also discussed her plans for a future pregnancy. I have reassured her that her current medication regimen is considered safe for both conception and pregnancy. To ensure she has specialized support, I will refer her to the IBD pregnancy clinic at St Vincent's Hospital for formal preconception counselling and ongoing monitoring. Furthermore, we discussed skin health and the increased risk of non-melanoma skin cancer associated with azathioprine. I have advised her to be diligent with photoprotection, particularly as she is considering laser therapy and skin bleaching treatments.

Impression and Plan

Harpreet will continue with her infliximab and azathioprine. I have advised her to repeat her liver function tests in two weeks, and I will contact her should any significant abnormalities persist. From a dietary perspective, we discussed the importance of a high-fibre, plant-based diet for microbiome health. I have planned a formal

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review in three months to evaluate her clinical response to the infliximab.

Yours sincerely,

A/Prof Chamara Basnayake
Gastroenterologist

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065